



COUNTY OF SONOMA

575 ADMINISTRATION
DRIVE, ROOM 102A
SANTA ROSA, CA 95403

SUMMARY REPORT

Agenda Date: 5/14/2019

To: Board of Supervisors of Sonoma County
Department or Agency Name(s): Sheriff's Office
Staff Name and Phone Number: Jody Like, Department Analyst, EH 565-2175
Vote Requirement: Majority
Supervisorial District(s): All

Title:

Boating Safety and Enforcement Financial Aid Program Agreement

Recommended Actions:

Adopt a resolution authorizing the Sheriff to execute an agreement with the State's Division of Boating and Waterways to receive grant funding for provision of boating safety and enforcement services in an amount not -to-exceed \$513,899 for FY 19-20. The grant promotes safety on Sonoma County's waterways while also reducing the County's General Fund contribution for the Marine Unit's activities. □

Executive Summary:

The Sheriff's Office is seeking the Board's approval to execute an agreement with the California Department of Parks and Recreation, Division of Boating and Waterways, Boating Safety and Enforcement Financial Aid Program; and authorization for the Sheriff to accept \$513,899 for FY 19-20 to support the Marine Unit's boating safety and enforcement activities on Sonoma County waterways, including Bodega Bay and Lake Sonoma, and portions of the Russian River, Petaluma River/San Pablo Bay, Gualala River, and coastal Pacific Ocean.

Discussion:

The Sonoma County Sheriff's Office Marine Unit maintains primary law enforcement jurisdiction over Sonoma County's waterways including Bodega Bay and Lake Sonoma, and portions of the Russian River, Petaluma River/San Pablo Bay, Gualala River, and coastal Pacific Ocean.

The California Department of Parks and Recreation, Division of Boating and Waterways provides financial aid to subvention grantees for boating safety and enforcement expenses. The purpose of the program is to provide financial aid to local governmental agencies whose waterways have high usage by transient boaters and an insufficient boat tax base to fully support a boating safety and enforcement program. The program is intended to augment existing local resources for boating safety and enforcement activities and is not intended to fully fund these programs.

The Sheriff's Office has received grant funds from the Division of Boating and Waterways since 1985. Most recently, in December 2018, Sheriff's Office staff submitted a subvention grant application and received an award of \$513,899, the maximum for which the County is eligible in FY 19-20. As a grantee in the financial aid

program, the Marine Unit can claim reimbursement for direct program-related costs including personnel, operations, equipment, maintenance, and administration up to \$513,899. Costs related to peace officer training, weapons, and the purchase of vessels or vehicles, and one-time payments for separation or medical causes are ineligible for reimbursement. The grant will subsidize and offset more than half of the FY 19-20 projected costs associated with providing law enforcement services on Sonoma County waterways.

Historically, Marine Unit revenue has come from the annual subvention grant from the Division of Boating and Waterways and from a contract with the U. S. Army Corps of Engineers to provide law enforcement services during the main recreation season at Lake Sonoma, including holidays, May through September. The Unit is authorized for three staff allocations: two deputies and a sergeant. The Unit uses alternate marine deputies as a pool of trained personnel available to relieve sick, vacation and training time of full-time deputies.

SHERIFF'S OFFICE MARINE UNIT BUDGET	FY 19-20 Recommended
Revenue	
Division of Boating and Waterways, Boating Safety and Enforcement Grant	\$513,899
Division of Boating and Waterways, SAVE grant	\$40,000
Army Corps of Engineers	\$160,000
TOTAL REVENUE	\$713,899
Expenses	
Salary and Benefits	\$923,661
Services and Supplies	\$216,177
TOTAL EXPENDITURES	\$1,139,778
GENERAL FUND NET COST	\$425,879

The \$1.1 million in expenditures are included in the Sheriff's Office FY 19-20 Recommended Budget, including the \$425,879 in General Fund support. The Sheriff's Office is the law enforcement agency responsible for monitoring and responding to calls for service on all waterways in Sonoma County, whether it receives funding from the Division of Boating and Waterways or not. Funding from this grant assists the Sheriff's Office in meeting its law enforcement obligations. If the County does not accept this grant funding, additional General Fund contributions beyond the projected \$425,879 would be needed to maintain current service levels.

The Sheriff's Office recommends the Board adopt the resolution authorizing the Sheriff to execute the agreement with the California Department of Parks and Recreation, Division of Boating and Waterways, Boating Safety and Enforcement Financial Aid Program to accept \$513,899 in FY 19-20 funding assistance for provision of the Marine Unit's boating safety and enforcement services

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Prior Board Actions:

Subvention grant agreements with the Division of Boating and Waterways have been approved annually since 1985, most recently Resolution 18-0070 on February 27, 2018. □

FISCAL SUMMARY

Expenditures	FY 18-19 Adopted	FY19-20 Projected	FY 20-21 Projected
Budgeted Expenses		\$1,139,778	
Additional Appropriation Requested			
Total Expenditures		\$1,139,778	
Funding Sources			
General Fund/WA GF		\$425,879	
State/Federal		\$713,899	
Fees/Other			
Use of Fund Balance			
Contingencies			
Total Sources		\$1,139,778	

Narrative Explanation of Fiscal Impacts:

The subvention grant provides State reimbursement for Sheriff's Office Marine Unit boating safety and enforcement expenses, not to exceed \$513,899 for FY 19-20. The Sheriff's Office Marine Unit FY 19-20 Recommended Budget includes funding from two grants, a federal contract, and the General Fund. The General Fund contribution of \$425,879 is augmented by an estimated \$157,259 in local boat tax revenue collected by the County in FY 18-19.

Staffing Impacts:			
Position Title (Payroll)	Monthly Salary Range (A - I Step)	Additions (number)	Deletions (number)

Narrative Explanation of Staffing Impacts (If Required):

None

Attachments:

1. Resolution authorizing execution of the Division of Boating and Waterways Financial Aid Program Agreement
2. Division of Boating and Waterways Financial Aid Program Agreement

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Related Items “On File” with the Clerk of the Board:

None